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As I Was Saying

BOB INGRAM

SPORTS EDITOR

TWC and Kentucky

A WESTERN ATHLETIC Conference scout's high appraisal of the Texas Western Miners, as carried in Abe Chanin's column in the Arizona Daily Star of Tucson: "Texas Western has to be one of the best in the nation. The Miners are a better team than UCLA, the defending national champion. If everything fell right in tournament play, Texas Western could go into the finals. I wouldn't be a bit surprised if it is Texas Western against Kentucky for the national collegiate championship."

Adolph Rupp, the Kentucky coach, was asked once if his team would consider playing in El Paso. "We would," he said, "but it would cost you a lot of money." Now, what if Kentucky played El Paso's Miners in the national finals at the University of Maryland campus on March 19? It's a game to dream about, anyway.

And on to Saturday eystems. Sign on El Paso florist company's delivery truck: "Drive Carefully Or The Next Load May Be For You." What they're doing now: Winston Llenas, little El Paso infielder last year, homered in a recent game of the Dominican Winter League. Danilo Rivas, left hander, is one of the leading hurlers in the league. Sporting News story from Santo Domingo, D.R., says Rivas is on the El Paso roster. He hurled one game for the Sun Kings last spring and then was traded to the Houston Astros organization. Maybe he's back in the California Angels farm group. And did you hear of the man who was suffering from athlete's foot? He was kicked by a football player.

Six in 5 Seasons

TEXAS WESTERN has lost only six games on its Memorial court in the five seasons of its existence. Two losses were to Arizona State. New Mexico defeated the Miners twice here. Colorado State had one win and Wichita one. Don Haskins, the TWC coach, says the games between the Miners and New Mexico Lobos are getting to be more of an El Paso-Albuquerque rivalry than one between the two schools. Walt Wiggins is returning to Ruidoso Downs to head the publicity staff of the mountain track. Harry James, the sports information director of University of Utah, has resigned to go into a private venture. He's also been the school's tennis coach, operating both jobs from a wheel chair. Utah will play the Miners in basketball on their Salt Lake City court but won't come to El Paso. Service station on Paisano drive has its own national basketball rating system. On a sign in small letters is: "Kentucky No. 1." In much bigger letters is: "Texas Western No. 2." Andy Cohen has quite a schedule for his Texas Western baseball team. He plays one El Paso series with the University of Oklahoma. Pressure is going to be on his team, the trackmen and tennis and golf players to do as well as the TWC football and basketball teams have done. And Mary Huana says she plans to hire a private eye from basketball players because so many of them are good keyhole operators.

No TWC Standouts

IT'S ALMOST All-American time in basketball. The Miners, with a team third nationally rated, should land somebody. The question is who. It's a team without the kind of a standout as was Jim Barnes. Seven different players have been high scorers in the 19 games the Miners have played to date. Bobby Joe Hill has been high man five times and shared the honor in one game with Nevil Shed. Shed has been the top scorer by himself four times. Other high scorers: Harry Flournoy 1, Orsten Artis 3, David Lattin 3, Willie Worsley 1, Willie Cager 1. Swell name for a winning greyhound: Swell Ed. Signs of progress: Wrestling matches as basketball halftime entertainment. Bob Hansen, the 232-pound Arizona guard who hit so well from the key against the Miners here recently, is a pitcher in baseball and is counted on to help the Wildcats have a winning season this spring. Fellow saw headline with TWU in it. He wanted to know if Texas Western College had become Texas Western University. TWU, however, meant Transit Workers Union. Whatever became of that expression, "setting up at charity lane?" Texas Western has played so many hair-raisers, heart-thumpers and ulcer-producers that if the Miners win by a big or comfortable margin it may not be interesting to see.

I WONDER

If news clippings stress
The value of the press
In basketball . . .
And if players who shoot hooks
Get them from the books.